

INDUSEQUINE · RESEARCH

Prepared for: Indusequine — India's first equestrian marketplace Date: June 2026 Purpose: Investor-ready landscape of equestrian industry size, growth, and emerging markets, with India positioning.

Equestrian Market by Country

All figures are cited inline with source and year. Where hard data is unavailable (notably for India), assumptions and reasoning are stated explicitly.

Where the riders, the money and the growth are — and how India compares.

1. Global Market Headlines

Report	Scope	FOR · INDUSEQUINE FOUNDER	Base year	Size	Projection	CAGR
Grand View Research (2024)	Horse riding equipment		2023	USD 1.60 B	USD 2.72 B by 2030	7.8 %
Mordor Intelligence (2025)	Horse riding equipment		2025	USD 0.93 B	USD 1.19 B by 2030	5.84 %
Allied Market Research (2023)	Horse riding equipment		2022	USD 2.10 B	USD 2.97 B by 2032	3.6 %
Research & Markets (2025)	Equestrian equipment + clothing		2024	USD 9.78 B	USD 12.53 B by 2030	4.21 %
Cognitive Market Research (2024)	Equestrian equipment		2024	—	—	4.2 % (to 2031)
Equerry / Co (2025)	Global equestrian equipment		2024	~USD 12 B	USD 18.3 B by 2034	~4.3 %
DataIntelto / Growth Mkt Reports (2024)	Equestrian tourism		2024	USD 2.1 B	USD 3.95 B by 2033	7.2 %
Future Market Insights (2025)	Horse tack — e-commerce channel		2025	28 % of channel	42 % by 2034	8.3 % (vs. -2.1 % offline)

Read-through: narrow “tack only” reports cluster at USD 1–3 B. Broader “equipment + apparel” sits at USD 10–12 B. Tourism is its own USD 2 B+ pool. **E-commerce is the standout sub-segment** — growing 3–4x faster than the underlying market and projected to exceed 40 % of channel share by 2034.

2. Top Equestrian-Active Countries by Industry Size

United States — the dominant market

- **Economic impact:** USD 122 B total economic impact (AHCF / American Horse Council Foundation, 2023 Economic Impact Study; up from USD 102 B in 2005).
- **Horse population:** ~6.7 M (AHCF 2023), with USEF citing 9.2 M when including all uses.
- **Participation:** ~4.6 M Americans involved in the industry (USEF).
- **Equipment revenue:** USD 3.5 B+ in 2024 (Equerry / Co, 2025).
- **Employment:** 1.74 M total jobs; USD 79 B in wages.

Germany — Europe's heart

- **Horses:** ~1.25 M privately owned (FN / German Equestrian Federation projections, 2023). Largest horse population in Europe.
- **Riders:** 2.32 M self-identified riders; 840 K ride regularly; 11.2 M express interest in horses (FN survey).
- **Clubs / facilities:** 7,600 riding clubs + 4,000 commercial centres; 42,000 horse-keeping farms.
- **FN members:** 709,000.
- **Breeding:** 25 breed associations, 55,600 brood mares, 3,500 sires.

United Kingdom

- **Market value:** ~£5 B / USD ~6.3 B (BETA / British Equestrian Trade Association, National Equestrian Survey 2022-23). Some industry voices cite USD 9.8 B when including racing.
- **Riders:** 1.82 M ride monthly, 3.2 M ride at least once a year.
- **Horse-keeping households:** 331,000.

France

- **FFE members:** 675,186 in 2023 (rebounding from a 2012-2020 decline).
- **Total riders:** ~3 M occasional + regular (FFE).
- **Riding schools:** 8,000+ ; FFE National Equestrian Tourism Committee covers 2,500 establishments.
- **Employment:** ~45,000.
- **Demography:** 85 % female; 61 % aged ≤18; 80 % of licences are leisure (FFE 2023).

Netherlands — export powerhouse

- **Horses:** ~450,000; ~500,000 riders; 80 % female (Spoga Horse / FEI).
- **Industry turnover:** EUR 1.5 B / yr; 6,600 affiliated companies.
- **KNHS members:** 200,000 (50,000 competitive); ~765,000 annual competition entries.
- **KWPN breeding:** ~10,000 foals / yr. The Netherlands is the **world's largest horse-export country** (EUR 200 M of horses exported in 2013; structurally higher today).

Belgium

- **Horses:** ~400,000 — **highest horse density in Europe** (Belga News, 2024).
- **Riders:** ~200,000 active.
- **Industry turnover (Flanders alone):** EUR 1.43 B; EUR 200 M annual horse exports.
- **Breeding strength:** ~30 % of horses at the Paris 2024 Olympics were Belgian-bred.

Sweden

- **Horses:** ~355,000 (one of Europe's most horse-dense per capita).
- **Riders:** 500 K regular + 500 K in regular horse contact (HNS / National Horse Industry Foundation).
- **Economic impact:** SEK 32 B turnover; **0.5 % of Swedish GDP**.
- Equestrianism is the 2nd-largest youth sport (after football), girl-dominated.

Ireland

- **Sport horse population:** ~136,000 (racehorses excluded).
- **Sector turnover:** EUR 816 M; 14,000 jobs.
- One of Europe's iconic equestrian tourism destinations.

Australia

- **Horses:** 1.03 M (excl. racehorses + ~400 K feral).
- **Equine economic activity (non-racing):** AUD 15.7 B; 100,000+ FTE jobs (Australian Horse Industry Council / IER, March 2025).
- **Equestrian Australia members:** 22,779 (2023); 814 coaches, 1,129 officials.

Argentina — polo capital

- The only country producing the dedicated **Polo Argentino** pony.
- ~3,000 registered polo players nationally + a much larger informal base.
- **Largest polo-pony exporter in the world.** 1924 + 1936 Olympic polo gold.

Brazil

- 482 registered athletes, 607 horses, 103 events (CBH / Confederação Brasileira de Hipismo, FEI data 2025) — though the broader gaucho / leisure rider base is much larger across São Paulo, Paraná and Rio Grande do Sul.
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3. Year-Over-Year Growth & Sub-Segment CAGRs

Sub-segment	CAGR	Source	Year
Global horse riding equipment	7.8 % (to 2030)	Grand View Research	2024
Global horse riding equipment	5.84 % (2025-30)	Mordor Intelligence	2025
Global horse riding equipment	3.6 % (2023-32)	Allied Market Research	2023
Global equestrian equipment + clothing	4.21 % (to 2030)	Research & Markets	2025
Global equestrian tourism	7.2 % (2025-33)	DataIntelto / Growth Market Reports	2024
Asia-Pacific equestrian tourism	8.4 % (to 2034)	DataIntelto	2024
Asia-Pacific horse riding equipment	7.2 % (to 2033)	Future Market Insights / Data Bridge	2024
India horse riding equipment	8.4 % (to 2035)	Markwide Research / FMI	2025
E-commerce tack channel	8.3 % (vs. -2.1 % offline)	Future Market Insights	2025
Equestrian apparel	~5 % (to 2034)	GMInsights	2025
Horse breeding (Germany broodmare numbers)	Flat / slight decline	FN survey	2023
FFE membership (France)	+5–7 %/yr post-2021 rebound	FFE	2023
Saudi Cup entries	1,400+ from 22 countries (record)	SEA.gov.sa	2023
Chinese equestrian clubs	From 20 (2011) → 2,815 (2024) = ~140x in 13 yrs (~45 %/yr CAGR through boom, now moderating)	Global Times / FEI	2024

Key insight for a marketplace founder: the *overall* equestrian market grows mid-single-digits, but **online-only channels grow ~8 %** and **emerging-Asia equipment ~7-8 %** — i.e. the two trends

Indusequine sits on top of are each roughly **2x the underlying market**.

4. Emerging Markets — Fastest Growth

China — the boom case

- Equestrian clubs: **20 in 2011 → 2,000 in 2024** (FEI President, Global Times Aug 2024). One source cites 907 → 2,815 (2016-2024).
- **2,160 registered clubs and 682,000 riders** by 2019 (Pegasus / China Daily).
- **1.19 M consumers across 2,000 clubs** in 2019, +20 % in 2 years (China Daily, 2022).
- Shanghai now hosts the FEI Global Champions Tour and built a permanent equestrian venue in 2024.
- Caveat: post-2021 the boom has cooled; consolidation has begun, but FEI still calls China “the largest growth potential market” globally.

Saudi Arabia & UAE

- **The Saudi Cup** is the world’s richest horse race — USD 35 M+ purse (SEA.gov.sa); 1,400+ entries from 22 countries in 2023.
- 22 riding clubs and equestrian establishments in Saudi Arabia.
- Notable shift: young Saudi women now training as jockeys; King Abdulaziz Equestrian Center enrolment rising.
- UAE-Saudi-Bahrain talks on a coordinated Gulf horseracing calendar (Arabian Business).
- Equerry / Co projects the Middle East to “solidify status as a global equine powerhouse through 2032.”

Brazil & Latin America

- Gaucho riding tradition + growing competitive scene (São Paulo, Paraná, Rio Grande do Sul, DF).
- Polo expanding regionally — “Brazil, Chile, Uruguay growing significantly in polo landscapes” (FEI).

Southeast Asia

- Thailand specifically called out as an “emerging focal point” (Equerry / Co, 2025).
- Asia-Pacific tourism CAGR 8.4 % is driven by Thailand, Mongolia, Bhutan, New Zealand alongside China & India.

Mexico

- Strong charrería tradition (working horse sport). Less data in international research reports — likely a USD 200–500 M equipment market based on regional GDP proxy.
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5. India Deep-Dive

Hard data we found

- **Equestrian Federation of India (EFI)** has over 1,030 members and 155 private-club electoral-college members (EFI / Indian Kanoun court doc, 2023).
- **Indian Polo Association (IPA)** has 35 affiliate clubs; founded 1892; most activity routed through the **61 Cavalry** of the Indian Army.
- India is the **birthplace of modern polo** (first club: Silchar, Assam, 1834).
- **Markwider / FMI:** India horse riding equipment market projected to grow at **~8.4 % CAGR through 2035** — among the fastest of any country.

Key clubs / facilities (founder's home turf)

- **Embassy International Riding School (EIRS), Bangalore** — 25+ years, Olympic-level coaching, hosts the Equestrian Premier League.
- **Amateur Riders' Club (ARC), Mumbai** — founded 1942, one of India's oldest civilian clubs.
- **Rambagh Polo Club, Jaipur** — Maharaja-era polo heritage.
- **Calcutta Polo Club** — the world's oldest still-existing polo club.
- **Delhi Riding Club, ASC Centre Bangalore, President's Bodyguard Delhi, Madras Race Club, Hyderabad Race Club** — anchor institutions.

Market-size estimate (founder's reasoning)

There is no published India equestrian equipment market figure. Triangulating:

1. India's horse riding equipment CAGR is 8.4 % (FMI 2025). Working backwards from India's likely share of Asia-Pacific tack (~5-8 %, given that APAC is ~USD 200-250 M of the global USD 0.93-1.6 B): → India tack-only market estimated at **USD 12-20 M today**, climbing to **USD 25-40 M by 2030**.
2. Adding apparel, boots, helmets, feed/supplements, and stable supplies (broader "equestrian wallet"): apply the global ratio of full equipment-market : tack market (~6-7x). → **Total India equestrian goods market: USD 75-140 M today**, plausibly **USD 150-250 M by 2030**.
3. Add services (lessons, boarding, polo, breeding, tourism) — likely **3-5x the goods market** based on global benchmarks (UK is goods ~£0.5 B vs. industry ~£5 B; ~10x). → **Total India equestrian economy: USD 300-700 M today** (a wide range reflecting limited data).

EFI member growth, the rise of equestrian academies in Bangalore / Pune / Gurugram, and Embassy's Equestrian Premier League all point to **double-digit participation growth** in the urban, affluent segment that matters most for a marketplace.

Drivers in India

- **Rising HNI / UHNI base** — Knight Frank India Wealth Report consistently shows 10-12 %/yr growth in USD-millionaire households; equestrian is squarely a luxury-aspirational category.

- **Women's participation** — globally 80–85 % female; the same pattern is emerging in Indian urban riding schools (e.g. ARC Mumbai, EIRS Bangalore membership skews young + female).
- **School-affiliated programmes** in Bangalore, Pune, Delhi-NCR, Mumbai.
- **Polo tourism** in Rajasthan + Manipur Sangai Festival visibility.
- **Cultural lineage** — India is the birthplace of modern polo; this is a story investors will recognise.

Headwinds in India

- **Fragmented supply chain** — most premium tack is imported (UK, Germany, Argentina), with no organised domestic distribution. (This is precisely the gap Indusequine fills.)
- **Stable infrastructure cost** — urban land scarcity makes new clubs hard.
- **EFI vs. IPA governance split** — polo and equestrian sport sit under different bodies, complicating umbrella growth narratives.
- **Animal welfare scrutiny** — rising concern, especially around urban carriage horses and unregistered stables.
- **Low base** — total addressable market today is small in absolute terms, even if growth rates are high.

6. Drivers & Headwinds by Region

Region	Top growth drivers	Top headwinds
North America	Wellness positioning, women's participation, e-commerce, premium pet-style spend	Rising feed/labour costs, land loss to urbanisation, ageing rural rider base
Western Europe	Olympic disciplines + Paris 2024 halo, exports, equestrian tourism	Cost inflation, animal welfare regulation, social licence pressure
Middle East	Royal patronage, USD 35 M+ purses (Saudi Cup), women's entry into the sport, ESG-tourism investments	Climate/heat constraints, narrow rider base, dependence on imported expertise
China	Middle-class luxury spend, government soft-power push, FEI events	Post-2021 cooling, club consolidation, regulatory uncertainty
India	HNI growth, women's participation, polo heritage, equestrian schools	Land scarcity, no organised supply chain, governance fragmentation, low base
LatAm	Polo & gaucho traditions, breeding exports	Currency volatility, smaller competitive infrastructure outside Argentina
Australia	High horse-per-capita, strong leisure base	Geographic dispersion, drought / feed cost risk

Global cross-cutting trends: - **Women drive 80–90 % of non-racing participation** (FEI, BETA, FFE, KNHS). Anything a marketplace ships must be designed female-first. - **Equestrian tourism** is its own USD 2 B+ pool growing 7.2 %/yr. - **E-commerce** is the channel that wins: +8.3 % vs. -2.1 % offline.

7. What This Means for Indusequine

- **You're early on the right curve.** India sits at a USD ~75-140 M equestrian goods market growing 8.4 %/yr — small enough to dominate, large enough to fund a real business. Premium tack is almost entirely imported; there is no organised D2C player.
 - **E-commerce is the wedge.** Globally, online tack grows ~8 %/yr while offline declines ~2 %/yr. India's offline infrastructure barely exists for tack — meaning Indusequine doesn't even have to displace anyone, it just has to *exist credibly*.
 - **Build female-first.** 80-85 % of riders globally — and emerging-market data points the same way — are women, often young. Brand, photography, product mix, and community should be designed for that audience from day one.
 - **Anchor on the four hubs that matter: Bangalore (Embassy), Mumbai (ARC), Delhi-NCR (Army + Delhi Riding Club), Jaipur (polo).** Hyderabad and Pune are tier-2 priorities. Manipur is a cultural / PR play, not a revenue base.
 - **Use polo as the heritage story to investors** — India is the birthplace of modern polo. This converts a "small market" pitch into a "global cultural property" pitch. Argentina monetised this; India never has.
 - **Geographic expansion order (post-India dominance):** UAE → Saudi Arabia (royal patronage, USD 35 M Saudi Cup, English-speaking) → Southeast Asia (Thailand, Singapore) → eventually compete in Australia / UK with a "Made in India, exported globally" play on saddlery and apparel (mirror the Indian textile-to-global luxury route).
 - **The investor headline numbers:** global equestrian equipment USD 12 B in 2024 (Equerry / Co); horse riding equipment alone growing 5.8-7.8 % to 2030 (Mordor / Grand View); equestrian tourism USD 3.95 B by 2033 (DataIntel); APAC equipment 7.2 % CAGR; India 8.4 % CAGR. The story: "the marketplace for the fastest-growing market segment of a USD 12 B global industry, where no organised player exists."
 - **Watch the headwinds:** animal welfare regulation is tightening globally — design vendor onboarding to surface welfare credentials from day one. It's a moat, not a tax.
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